Acknowledgements

For this book, I owe many my thanks.

First and foremost, to my family, who took turns in encouraging me to persist every time I hit a writer's block.

To my husband, Ashish, who would thoughtfully remind me every day, to get a little done and inspire me with the discipline he brought to writing his own book *Heritage Retailers of Bombay*. To my mother, Banu, for her unwavering support and encouragement, and her daily morning prayers that have blessed and protected me. To my brother, Manik, who gave me haven in his tranquil home by the river Pampa in Kerala, where much of this book was written – which sadly was submerged and badly damaged in the recent deluge – as also for his valuable inputs. And above all, to my children, Priyadarshini and Jai, who helped me edit and format the book, to make it both crisper and more comprehensible.

Much of the pleasure in writing this book came from trying to unravel the mystery behind the unanswered questions of India's 2016 demonetization. There was a wealth of information available – the challenge was to try and join the dots, to sift rumour from fact, and to identify meaningful data that could present a factual and objective picture of the events and outcomes of this move.

For this, I would like to acknowledge the individuals and institutions from which I drew much of my information and data.